

The world knew me
by another family name.

But before my wedding,
two women placed the final Kerongsang brooch into my hands.

Only then did I finally understand
why my gemstone never matched the family I grew up in.

My mother and aunt carried a promise
their entire lives.

Before their youngest sister died,
they swore her child would never be abandoned.

And they carried that promise with them
to the grave.

— *The Third Orchid*



Password Digit: **3**